

30+
MARBLE EFFECTS

Complete Recipe Guide



• MARBLE EFFECTS LAB •



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MARBLE

EFFECTS GUIDE



Discover the art of creating timeless
marble effects with confidence.



From classic white marble to bold modern statements, this
guide will take you step by step through techniques,
materials, and inspiration to achieve stunning results.



Carrara White

01

EASY

1.5–2 HRS ACTIVE

CLASSIC ITALIAN MARBLE

The most iconic marble in the world — soft white background with delicate grey veining. Perfect for bathrooms, feature walls, and fireplaces.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2 kg
- Black pigment — 5 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 3 ml
- White base paint — 500 ml
- Fine sandpaper 400 grit
- Clear matte sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of pure white base paint. Let each coat dry completely (2 hours minimum).
- 2 Mix white putty with a tiny amount of black and raw umber to create a very light warm grey.
- 3 Load a small amount onto the spatula edge. Hold at a 15–20° angle to the wall.
- 4 Create veins by dragging the spatula diagonally in long, flowing movements. Carrara veins flow in one direction.
- 5 Vary pressure: lighter = thinner veins, heavier = broader. Leave generous white space.
- 6 Burnish the veined areas with a clean, dry spatula in the same diagonal direction.
- 7 Add one or two secondary veins branching off the main ones at slight angles — thinner and lighter.
- 8 Let dry 6–8 hours. Sand lightly with 400 grit. Wipe dust.
- 9 Apply clear matte sealer — two coats, 2 hours apart.

Pro Tip: Study real Carrara marble on your phone while working. One bold vein with two lighter companions is the natural pattern.

Drying: 12–24 hours total



Calacatta Gold

02

MEDIUM

2-2.5 HRS ACTIVE

PREMIUM ITALIAN MARBLE

The most luxurious marble — bright white with bold, dramatic gold and grey veining. Commands premium pricing from clients.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Yellow ochre pigment — 8 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 5 ml
- Black pigment — 3 ml
- Burnt sienna pigment — 3 ml
- White base paint — 500 ml
- Fine sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of pure white base paint. Dry 2+ hours per coat.
- 2 Prepare two vein mixes: (A) putty + yellow ochre + burnt sienna for golden veins; (B) putty + black + raw umber for grey veins.
- 3 Start with golden mix (A). Apply bold diagonal veins — Calacatta veins are thicker and dramatic.
- 4 While still wet, add grey veins (B) alongside and partially overlapping. This creates warm-meets-cool depth.
- 5 Lightly blend where the two colors meet, but leave areas of sharp transition.
- 6 Add fine secondary veins from the corner of your spatula.
- 7 Burnish the entire surface with long, smooth passes. Dry 8 hrs. Sand. Apply satin sealer — two coats.

Pro Tip: Calacatta's wow factor comes from contrast. Don't be afraid of bold veins. Leave pure, clean white space between them.

Drying: 12-24 hours total

Emperador Dark

03

MEDIUM

2-3 HRS ACTIVE

RICH DARK SPANISH MARBLE

Deep, warm brown marble with intricate lighter veining. Dramatic and sophisticated for accent walls, bars, and luxury spaces.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Burnt umber pigment — 20 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 10 ml
- Black pigment — 8 ml
- Yellow ochre pigment — 5 ml
- White pigment — 10 ml
- Dark brown base paint — 500 ml
- Fine sandpaper 320 grit
- Satin sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of dark chocolate brown base paint. Dry 2+ hours per coat.
- 2 Mix main body: putty + burnt umber + raw umber + a little black. Rich espresso brown.
- 3 Apply a thin, textured layer over the entire wall. Leave subtle texture.
- 4 Prepare vein mix: putty + yellow ochre + white pigment for warm cream veins.
- 5 Create a web-like network of veins — Emperador has more frequent, shorter veins that branch and reconnect.
- 6 Add thinner veins using just white putty for brighter highlights.
- 7 Blend and soften vein edges. Add depth with a thin dark glaze over some areas.
- 8 Dry 8+ hrs. Sand with 320 grit. Apply satin sealer — two coats.

Pro Tip: Build layers: dark base → brown texture → light veins → selective dark glaze. Each layer should be visible in the final result.

Drying: 16-24 hours total

Nero Marquina

04

MEDIUM

2 HRS ACTIVE

BLACK SPANISH MARBLE

Striking black marble with bold white veining from the Basque region. One of the most dramatic and modern-looking marble effects.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2 kg
- Black pigment — 25 ml
- White pigment — 15 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 3 ml
- Black base paint — 500 ml
- Fine sandpaper 400 grit
- Gloss sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of pure black base paint. Dry 2+ hours per coat.
- 2 Mix white putty + white pigment for bright, opaque white veins.
- 3 Also prepare subtle grey: putty + small amount of black + touch of raw umber.
- 4 Apply bold white veins diagonally. Nero Marquina veins are confident and dramatic.
- 5 Add grey alongside the white veins for shadow and depth.
- 6 Mix thick and thin veins — the contrast makes this marble striking.
- 7 Burnish lightly. Dry 8+ hrs. Sand with 400 grit.
- 8 Apply gloss sealer — two coats, 2 hours apart. High-shine looks best.

Pro Tip: The black base must be completely opaque. If wall color shows through, add a third coat. White veins on patchy black look amateurish.

Drying: 12–24 hours total

Statuario Veined

05

ADVANCED

2.5–3 HRS ACTIVE

ITALIAN LUXURY MARBLE

The marble of Michelangelo. Pure white with bold grey veins. The most prestigious marble — perfect upsell for high-end clients.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 3 kg
- Black pigment — 8 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 4 ml
- Yellow ochre pigment — 2 ml
- White base paint — 600 ml
- Fine sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of brilliant white base — the purest white, no warm tints.
- 2 Prepare main vein mix: putty + black + touch of raw umber for medium grey.
- 3 Prepare highlight mix: putty + yellow ochre for subtle warm accents.
- 4 Begin with bold, sweeping diagonal veins using grey — fewer but larger than Carrara.
- 5 Layer: add darker areas within the veins by adding more black pigment while still wet.
- 6 Add faint warm veins using ochre mix between the grey veins.
- 7 Burnish entire surface in long diagonal passes. Dry 6–8 hrs. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Statuario's veins have visible internal gradient — darker at center, lighter at edges. Vary pigment concentration within a single stroke.

Drying: 14–24 hours total

Travertine Classic

06

EASY

1.5–2 HRS ACTIVE

NATURAL STONE TEXTURE

A warm, earthy stone finish with natural pitting and horizontal banding. One of the easiest effects to execute and always looks impressive.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 3 kg
- Yellow ochre pigment — 15 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 8 ml
- Burnt sienna pigment — 5 ml
- Warm beige base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 320 grit
- Matte sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of warm beige base paint. Dry 2+ hours per coat.
- 2 Mix two shades: (A) putty + yellow ochre + raw umber for warm tan; (B) putty + burnt sienna + raw umber for deeper brown.
- 3 Apply mix A in random patches using the wide trowel. Work horizontally — travertine has horizontal banding.
- 4 While wet, apply mix B in smaller patches within the first layer.
- 5 Lightly skip the trowel over the surface, creating natural pits and voids.
- 6 Let dry partially (30–45 min). Apply a thin topcoat of mix A, filling some pits but not all.
- 7 Burnish to polish the high points. Dry 8+ hrs. Sand. Apply matte sealer.

Pro Tip: The pits are what make travertine look real. Resist the urge to fill all of them. Too smooth = just a painted wall.

Drying: 12–24 hours total

Honey Onyx

07

ADVANCED

3–4 HRS ACTIVE

TRANSLUCENT WARM STONE

Stunning warm amber stone with translucent-looking layers and flowing patterns. Produces a breathtaking backlit-looking effect.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 3 kg
- Yellow ochre pigment — 20 ml
- Burnt sienna pigment — 10 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 5 ml
- White pigment — 10 ml
- Warm gold base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Gloss sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of warm gold/honey base paint.
- 2 Mix three batches: (A) light honey — putty + yellow ochre + white; (B) amber — putty + yellow ochre + burnt sienna; (C) dark caramel — putty + burnt sienna + raw umber.
- 3 Apply all three in flowing, organic swirls. Each color should blend into the next.
- 4 Mist the surface, then drag the wide trowel to create flowing, water-like patterns.
- 5 Add white highlights in lighter areas. Blend softly.
- 6 Let dry 4 hrs. Apply a thin second pass using light honey mix (A), letting darker layers show through.
- 7 Burnish firmly. Dry 8+ hrs. Sand. Apply 2–3 coats gloss sealer for maximum depth.

Pro Tip: Onyx's magic is in the layering. Each thin translucent layer adds depth. Rushing with one thick layer looks flat and muddy.

Drying: 24–36 hours total

Green Onyx

08

ADVANCED

3-4 HRS ACTIVE

EXOTIC TRANSLUCENT STONE

Exotic, jewel-like stone with deep emerald greens. Commands premium pricing — perfect for luxury bars, spas, and statement walls.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 3 kg
- Chrome green pigment — 15 ml
- Yellow ochre pigment — 8 ml
- Black pigment — 5 ml
- White pigment — 10 ml
- Forest green base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Gloss sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of deep forest green base paint.
- 2 Mix three batches: (A) light jade — putty + chrome green + white + yellow ochre; (B) emerald — putty + chrome green; (C) dark forest — putty + chrome green + black.
- 3 Apply in flowing organic patterns with a crystalline, angular quality.
- 4 Add veins of lighter color (A) cutting through the darker areas.
- 5 Mist with water and blend using the wide trowel in sweeping curves.
- 6 Let dry 4 hrs. Apply thin translucent second layer to build backlit illusion.
- 7 Burnish firmly. Dry 8+ hrs. Sand. Apply 2-3 coats gloss sealer.

Pro Tip: The lighter areas should look like they glow from within. Concentrate lightest mixture in center, getting darker toward edges.

Drying: 24-36 hours total

ADVANCED

3-4 HRS ACTIVE

DEEP BLUE SEMI-PRECIOUS STONE

Deep royal blue stone with white and grey inclusions. Rare and expensive in nature — particularly impressive and profitable as an effect.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 3 kg
- Ultramarine blue pigment — 20 ml
- Black pigment — 8 ml
- White pigment — 15 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 3 ml
- Dark navy base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Gloss sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of dark navy blue base paint.
- 2 Mix three batches: (A) royal blue — putty + ultramarine; (B) deep blue — putty + ultramarine + black; (C) white-grey veins — putty + white + touch of raw umber.
- 3 Apply A and B in large, irregular patches. Blend where they meet.
- 4 Press small amounts of mix C into the blue surface — angular, mineral-like white patches.
- 5 Partially blend white into blue at edges, leaving centers bright.
- 6 Add thin grey lines between larger patches.
- 7 Burnish firmly. Dry 8+ hrs. Sand. Apply 2-3 coats gloss sealer.

Pro Tip: Sodalite's white patches are irregular and blocky, not round or flowing. Think cracked ice frozen in deep blue water.

Drying: 24-36 hours total

Rosa Portogallo

10

EASY

1.5–2 HRS ACTIVE

WARM PINK ITALIAN MARBLE

Warm, rosy marble with soft coral and cream veining. Popular for bedrooms, powder rooms, and boutique retail spaces.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Red oxide pigment — 5 ml
- Yellow ochre pigment — 3 ml
- White pigment — 10 ml
- Warm pink base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of warm blush pink base paint.
- 2 Mix veins: putty + white pigment + touch of yellow ochre for cream-colored veins.
- 3 Mix body: putty + red oxide + yellow ochre for deeper coral patches.
- 4 Apply coral in soft, flowing areas. Leave most of the pink base visible.
- 5 Add cream veins flowing through and between coral areas.
- 6 Burnish gently — this marble should look soft, not sharply defined.
- 7 Dry 6+ hrs. Sand lightly. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Keep everything soft and warm. No hard edges, no dramatic contrast. Rosa Portogallo is about gentle warmth and elegance.

Drying: 12–24 hours total

Venetian Stucco

11

EASY

2-3 HRS ACTIVE

CLASSIC POLISHED PLASTER

The original Italian decorative wall finish. The foundation technique for all marble effects. Multiple thin layers burnished to a high sheen.

MATERIALS

- Venetian stucco / lime putty — 3 kg
- Pigment of choice — 15 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Wax sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 No base paint needed — apply directly to primed wall.
- 2 Tint the stucco with your chosen pigment. Start with less — add more as needed.
- 3 Apply the first coat with overlapping strokes. Cover the wall but leave visible texture.
- 4 Dry 4 hrs. Apply a second coat, slightly thinner, filling low spots.
- 5 Dry 4 hrs. Apply a third, very thin finishing coat in tight, firm strokes.
- 6 Burnish immediately: press hard with clean trowel, polish in circular motions. The friction generates heat that polishes the lime to a natural sheen.
- 7 Cure 24 hrs. Apply wax with lint-free cloth. Buff to desired sheen.

Pro Tip: The burnishing step is where the magic happens. Press hard and work fast — the surface should feel warm under the trowel.

Drying: 24-48 hours total

Concrete & Cement

12

EASY

1.5 HRS ACTIVE

INDUSTRIAL MODERN

The modern industrial aesthetic. Real concrete is cold and expensive — this effect gives you the look with none of the downsides.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 3 kg
- Black pigment — 10 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 5 ml
- Light grey base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 320 grit
- Matte sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of light grey base paint.
- 2 Mix two shades: (A) medium grey — putty + black + raw umber; (B) darker grey — more black.
- 3 Apply mix A in broad, random trowel strokes. Leave visible marks and texture — this is concrete.
- 4 While wet, add patches of mix B for subtle shadow variation. Blend loosely.
- 5 Optionally create "formwork lines" — subtle lines where concrete panels would meet.
- 6 Dry 6+ hrs. Sand with 320 grit — leave slightly rough.
- 7 Apply matte sealer — never use gloss for concrete.

Pro Tip: Real concrete is imperfect. Small air bubbles, slight color variation, and visible texture are what make this convincing.

Drying: 10–18 hours total

Crema Marfil

13

EASY

1.5–2 HRS ACTIVE

WARM IVORY MARBLE

Spain's most popular marble — warm ivory with subtle cream and light brown veining. Versatile, easy-to-sell for living rooms and lobbies.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Yellow ochre pigment — 10 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 5 ml
- Warm ivory base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of warm ivory base paint.
- 2 Mix veins: putty + raw umber + small amount of yellow ochre for subtle warm brown.
- 3 Apply gentle, flowing veins — Crema Marfil veins are soft and understated.
- 4 Create areas of slightly deeper warmth by troweling the vein mix in broad patches.
- 5 Burnish gently for a soft, warm finish.
- 6 Dry 6+ hrs. Sand lightly. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: This is the "safe choice" marble — it goes with everything. When a client can't decide, suggest Crema Marfil. It never clashes.

Drying: 12–20 hours total

Black & Gold Luxe

14

MEDIUM

2-3 HRS ACTIVE

ULTRA-LUXURY FINISH

Deep black base with bold golden veining. Inspired by Sahara Noir and Port Laurent but amplified for maximum luxury impact.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2 kg
- Black pigment — 25 ml
- Gold metallic pigment — 15 ml
- Yellow ochre pigment — 8 ml
- Black base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Gloss sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of jet black base paint. Must be perfectly opaque.
- 2 Mix golden vein mix: putty + gold metallic pigment + yellow ochre. It should shimmer.
- 3 Apply bold, dramatic golden veins with confident, sweeping strokes.
- 4 Add finer secondary gold veins branching from the main ones.
- 5 Burnish firmly — metallic pigment develops more sheen under pressure.
- 6 Dry 8+ hrs. Sand very lightly — don't dull the metallic sheen.
- 7 Apply gloss sealer — two coats for maximum depth and reflection.

Pro Tip: Less is more with gold veins. A few bold strokes on vast black look luxurious; too many look busy. Leave 60%+ black visible.

Drying: 14-24 hours total

Arabescato

15

MEDIUM

2–2.5 HRS ACTIVE

COMPLEX VEINED ITALIAN MARBLE

White marble with a complex network of grey and brown veins creating an almost abstract artistic pattern.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Black pigment — 8 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 5 ml
- Burnt sienna pigment — 3 ml
- White base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of pure white base paint.
- 2 Mix grey veins: putty + black + raw umber.
- 3 Mix warm accent: putty + burnt sienna + raw umber.
- 4 Create a dense network of interconnected grey veins forming irregular closed shapes, like a cracked surface.
- 5 Add warm accent touches within some vein intersections.
- 6 Burnish and blend to soften edges while maintaining the complex pattern.
- 7 Dry 6+ hrs. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Think "organized chaos." Veins form a web but flow in a general diagonal direction. Study real Arabescato for the right density.

Drying: 12–24 hours total

Quartzite Crystal

16

MEDIUM

2–3 HRS ACTIVE

CRYSTALLINE NATURAL STONE

Metamorphic stone with subtle sparkle and organic flowing patterns. Trending heavily in interior design as a marble alternative.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Pearl/mica pigment — 10 ml
- Grey pigment — 8 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 3 ml
- Off-white base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of off-white base paint.
- 2 Mix the main body: putty + pearl/mica pigment for subtle shimmer.
- 3 Mix veins: putty + grey + raw umber.
- 4 Apply pearlescent body across the surface in broad, sweeping strokes.
- 5 Add grey veins with a flowing, organic quality — like frozen water movement.
- 6 Burnish firmly — mica particles will catch the light beautifully when polished.
- 7 Dry 6+ hrs. Sand gently. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: The pearl/mica pigment is the secret ingredient. It makes the surface shimmer subtly when light hits at different angles.

Drying: 12–24 hours total

Epoxy Resin Marble

17

ADVANCED

3–5 HRS ACTIVE

HIGH-GLOSS RESIN TECHNIQUE

A completely different technique using epoxy resin. Creates ultra-high-gloss, depth-rich marble effect for countertops and feature areas.

MATERIALS

- Clear epoxy resin kit — 2 L
- White epoxy pigment — 20 ml
- Grey epoxy pigment — 10 ml
- Metallic gold pigment — 5 ml
- Heat gun or torch
- Mixing cups and stir sticks
- White primer spray — 1 can

STEPS

- 1 Prepare surface: clean, level, sealed. Apply white primer and let dry.
- 2 Mix epoxy per manufacturer instructions. Divide into three cups.
- 3 Tint cup 1 white (main body), cup 2 grey (veins), cup 3 metallic gold (accents).
- 4 Pour white over surface, spread evenly.
- 5 Drizzle grey in vein patterns. Add small amounts of gold along grey veins.
- 6 Use heat gun 15–20 cm above surface to pop bubbles and blend. Move continuously.
- 7 Use a skewer to draw through veins, creating organic movement.
- 8 Allow to self-level and cure 24–48 hrs in a dust-free environment.

Pro Tip: Temperature matters. Work in 20–25°C. Too cold = won't flow; too hot = cures too fast. Calculate 20% more resin than you think.

Curing: 24–72 hours

Thunder Grey

18

EASY

1.5–2 HRS ACTIVE

CONTEMPORARY GREY STONE

Modern grey marble with dramatic dark and light contrast. The go-to choice for contemporary, minimalist interiors.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Black pigment — 15 ml
- White pigment — 10 ml
- Medium grey base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of medium grey base paint.
- 2 Mix two shades: (A) dark grey — putty + black; (B) light grey — putty + white.
- 3 Apply dramatic streaks of both across the surface, creating strong tonal contrast.
- 4 Blend where tones meet, but leave areas of sharp contrast.
- 5 Add thin white veins cutting through darker areas.
- 6 Burnish firmly. Dry 6+ hrs. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Work in long, confident strokes — this effect is about drama and movement, not subtle blending.

Drying: 12–20 hours total

Sahara Gold

19

MEDIUM

2–2.5 HRS ACTIVE

NORTH AFRICAN WARM MARBLE

Rich golden-beige marble from North Africa with warm honey tones. Perfect for creating warm, inviting spaces with exotic luxury.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Yellow ochre pigment — 15 ml
- Burnt sienna pigment — 8 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 5 ml
- Gold/honey base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of warm honey/gold base paint.
- 2 Mix three shades of gold-to-brown using yellow ochre, burnt sienna, and raw umber in different proportions.
- 3 Apply in flowing, layered strokes creating warm tonal variation.
- 4 Add subtle darker veins using the deepest mixture.
- 5 Burnish for a warm, polished glow. Dry 6+ hrs. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: This effect relies on warmth. Avoid any cool tones (black, grey, blue). Keep everything in the yellow-brown family.

Drying: 12–24 hours total

Arctic White Quartz

20

- EASY
- 1-1.5 HRS ACTIVE
- CLEAN MODERN WHITE

The cleanest, whitest stone finish — minimal veining, maximum brightness. Perfect for kitchens, bathrooms, and modern minimalist spaces.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2 kg
- Black pigment — 2 ml
- Pearl/mica pigment — 5 ml
- White base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Matte sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of pure white base paint.
- 2 Mix body: putty + pearl pigment for subtle sparkle.
- 3 Apply across the entire surface in smooth, even passes.
- 4 Mix barely-there grey: putty + tiny amount of black.
- 5 Add extremely subtle veins — barely visible whispers of grey. Less is more.
- 6 Burnish smooth. Dry 4+ hrs. Sand. Apply matte sealer for a clean modern look.

Pro Tip: This effect is about restraint. Surface should look almost pure white, with veining only visible up close. Pearl shimmer does the heavy lifting.

Drying: 10-18 hours total

Tuscany Warm

21

EASY

1.5–2 HRS ACTIVE

TUSCAN VILLA PLASTER

Warm, aged Italian plaster reminiscent of old Tuscan villas. Subtle variation in warm earth tones creates an elegant atmosphere.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 3 kg
- Yellow ochre pigment — 12 ml
- Red oxide pigment — 5 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 5 ml
- Warm terra base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 320 grit
- Wax sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of warm terracotta-tinted base paint.
- 2 Mix warm body: putty + yellow ochre + red oxide for Tuscan terracotta.
- 3 Apply in overlapping, irregular trowel strokes. Leave texture — hand-crafted feel.
- 4 Add variation using lighter and darker versions of the same color family.
- 5 Burnish selectively — polish some areas smooth, leave others textured for aged effect.
- 6 Dry 8+ hrs. Sand lightly. Apply wax for a warm, natural patina.

Pro Tip: The beauty is in the imperfection. Think old Italian farmhouse walls — uneven, weathered, but full of character.

Drying: 14–24 hours total

Rosso Levanto

22

MEDIUM

2–2.5 HRS ACTIVE

DEEP RED ITALIAN MARBLE

Deep, dramatic burgundy-red marble with white veining. Bold and opulent — used in the grandest European palaces and cathedrals.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Red oxide pigment — 15 ml
- Black pigment — 10 ml
- White pigment — 12 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 5 ml
- Deep burgundy base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Gloss sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of deep burgundy base paint.
- 2 Mix body: putty + red oxide + black for rich, deep red-brown.
- 3 Apply textured patches of body color across the wall.
- 4 Mix white veins: putty + white + touch of raw umber for slightly warm white.
- 5 Apply dramatic white veins cutting through the dark red surface.
- 6 Burnish firmly for a polished, regal look. Dry 8+ hrs. Sand. Apply gloss sealer.

Pro Tip: Use on one accent wall, not all four. A full room of Rosso Levanto can feel overwhelming.

Drying: 14–24 hours total

MEDIUM

2–2.5 HRS ACTIVE

COOL-TONED MODERN MARBLE

Contemporary cool-toned marble with flowing silver-grey waves. Sophisticated and modern for bathrooms, offices, and living spaces.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Black pigment — 10 ml
- Silver metallic pigment — 8 ml
- White pigment — 10 ml
- Pale grey base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of very pale grey base paint.
- 2 Mix wave mix: putty + black + silver metallic for shimmering grey waves.
- 3 Apply in long, horizontal flowing strokes creating wave-like movement.
- 4 Add brighter silver highlights using putty + silver + white.
- 5 Burnish in the direction of the waves. Dry 6+ hrs. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Waves should flow in the same horizontal direction but at slightly varying angles — like ocean waves approaching shore.

Drying: 12–20 hours total

MEDIUM

2-2.5 HRS ACTIVE

DARK GREY PERSIAN MARBLE

Dark grey marble from Iran with fine white linear veining. One of the most sought-after stones in modern architecture.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Black pigment — 18 ml
- White pigment — 12 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 3 ml
- Dark grey base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of dark charcoal grey base paint.
- 2 Mix dark body: putty + black + touch of raw umber.
- 3 Apply a thin, slightly varied body layer across the surface.
- 4 Mix white veins: putty + white pigment for bright, clean lines.
- 5 Create thin, straight, parallel veins — Pietra Grey is linear and architectural.
- 6 Burnish firmly. Dry 6+ hrs. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Pietra Grey veins are remarkably linear — almost like ruled lines. Use a straightedge to guide your spatula if needed.

Drying: 12-24 hours total

Botticino Beige

25

EASY

1.5 HRS ACTIVE

CLASSIC WARM MARBLE

Classic warm beige marble from Italy. Neutral, versatile, and timeless — the safe choice that always looks good.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Yellow ochre pigment — 8 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 5 ml
- Warm beige base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of warm beige base paint.
- 2 Mix subtle veins: putty + raw umber for soft, barely-there veining.
- 3 Apply gentle veins — Botticino is understated.
- 4 Burnish for a smooth, warm finish. Dry 6+ hrs. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Choose Crema Marfil for warm spaces, Botticino for neutral ones. Botticino is cooler and more neutral.

Drying: 10–18 hours total

Midnight Blue Stone

26

MEDIUM

2-3 HRS ACTIVE

DEEP BLUE NATURAL STONE

Dark, mysterious blue stone with subtle lighter inclusions. Great for powder rooms, ceilings, and media rooms.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Ultramarine blue pigment — 15 ml
- Black pigment — 10 ml
- White pigment — 8 ml
- Dark navy base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of dark navy base paint.
- 2 Mix body: putty + ultramarine + black for deep midnight blue.
- 3 Apply in textured, layered strokes across the surface.
- 4 Add subtle lighter areas using putty + ultramarine + white.
- 5 Create very fine veins with the lighter mix.
- 6 Burnish firmly. Dry 6+ hrs. Sand. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: Keep it dark and moody. The beauty is the depth — don't make light areas too bright or frequent.

Drying: 12-24 hours total

Terracotta Rustic

27

EASY

1.5–2 HRS ACTIVE

MEDITERRANEAN WARMTH

Warm, textured terracotta reminiscent of Mediterranean walls. Organic, earthy, and inviting for kitchens and patios.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 3 kg
- Red oxide pigment — 15 ml
- Yellow ochre pigment — 10 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 5 ml
- Terracotta base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 220–320 grit
- Matte sealer or wax — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of terracotta base paint.
- 2 Mix warm body: putty + red oxide + yellow ochre. Create 2–3 slightly different shades.
- 3 Apply in rough, irregular patches. Leave texture and trowel marks — hand-plastered look.
- 4 While wet, scratch or scrape to reveal base coat for an aged, weathered look.
- 5 Dry 8+ hrs. Sand irregularly to enhance the aged feel.
- 6 Apply matte sealer or wax for a natural, earthy finish.

Pro Tip: Imperfection is the goal. The more handmade it looks, the more authentic it feels.

Drying: 14–24 hours total

Pearl Shimmer

28

EASY

1.5 HRS ACTIVE

PEARLESCENT FINISH

Soft, luminous finish with subtle mother-of-pearl shimmer. Popular for bedrooms, bridal suites, and high-end retail.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Pearl/mica pigment — 15 ml
- White pigment — 5 ml
- Off-white base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 400 grit
- Satin sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of off-white base paint.
- 2 Mix body: putty + pearl/mica pigment + white for luminous, pearlescent mix.
- 3 Apply in smooth, overlapping trowel strokes across the entire surface.
- 4 Create subtle movement by varying stroke direction — mica catches light differently.
- 5 Burnish firmly for maximum sheen. Dry 4+ hrs. Sand very lightly. Apply satin sealer.

Pro Tip: This effect shines most with directional lighting — a wall sconce or spotlight makes the pearl shimmer dance.

Drying: 10–18 hours total

Lava Stone Dark

29

EASY

1.5–2 HRS ACTIVE

VOLCANIC TEXTURE

Rugged volcanic stone finish. Dark, dramatic, and masculine for bars, game rooms, wine cellars, and industrial-chic spaces.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 3 kg
- Black pigment — 20 ml
- Raw umber pigment — 8 ml
- Charcoal base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 220–320 grit
- Matte sealer — 250 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of charcoal base paint.
- 2 Mix dark body: putty + black + raw umber.
- 3 Apply in thick, rough patches. Use trowel edge to create pitted, volcanic texture.
- 4 Leave the surface rough and uneven — lava stone is never smooth.
- 5 Dry 8+ hrs. Sand the high points only, leaving pits rough.
- 6 Apply matte sealer — never gloss for lava stone.

Pro Tip: Create volcanic pits by dabbing with crumpled paper towel while wet, then partially smoothing the high points.

Drying: 14–24 hours total

Industrial Oxide

30

EASY

1.5–2 HRS ACTIVE

OXIDIZED METAL EFFECT

Weathered, oxidized metal combining rusty oranges, verdigris greens, and aged copper tones. Popular for industrial and artistic spaces.

MATERIALS

- White acrylic putty — 2.5 kg
- Red oxide pigment — 15 ml
- Burnt sienna pigment — 10 ml
- Chrome green pigment — 8 ml
- Black pigment — 5 ml
- Dark brown base paint — 500 ml
- Sandpaper 320 grit
- Matte sealer — 200 ml

STEPS

- 1 Apply two coats of dark brown/rust base paint.
- 2 Mix three colors: (A) rust — putty + red oxide + burnt sienna; (B) oxidized green — putty + chrome green; (C) aged dark — putty + black + raw umber.
- 3 Apply mix A as primary color in irregular patches.
- 4 Add mix B where oxidation would occur — corners, edges, moisture areas.
- 5 Use mix C for shadow and depth in transitions.
- 6 Blend loosely — colors should transition naturally. Dry 6+ hrs. Sand selectively. Apply matte sealer.

Pro Tip: Study real oxidized copper. Water flows down and collects in crevices — that's where green oxidation appears. Real weathering logic makes it convincing.

Drying: 12–20 hours total



BONUS TECHNIQUES

Advanced Blends & Troubleshooting



MARBLE EFFECTS LAB

